Jefferson McMillan-Wilhoit

MPH · MPA · CHCIO · CDH-E

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

The rare health IT executive who can both lead the organization that needs the technology and personally build it.

CHCIO-certified CIO and cloud architect with 15+ years across clinical systems, public health enterprise, and AI infrastructure. Personally architected a 7-layer, HIPAA-compliant, multi-tenant AI platform on AWS — and previously held the CIO seat that such a platform was built for. Grows revenue 30×, builds teams with 0% undesirable turnover, and ships systems under real-world pressure. Constellation Research Business Transformation 150 honoree.

> **Constellation Research BT150 Honoree (2022)** — elite recognition for top global executives leading enterprise business transformation · **Media:** State Tech Magazine · GovTech · ABC News Chicago

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Oct 2022 – Present

Flourish & Thrive Labs (F&T Labs) · Grayslake, IL

WBE & SBA 8(a)-certified public health technology & consulting company

TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE

- **AWS Architect of Record:** Personally designed and built PH360's 7-layer, HIPAA-compliant, multi-tenant AI platform — AWS Bedrock, Lambda, S3, API Gateway, Cognito, CloudFormation — not as technical oversight but as the engineer who built it
- **AI Systems:** Architected RAG-based knowledge system and AI chatbot using AWS Bedrock and Claude LLM; built automated data processing pipelines for public health reporting workflows

BUSINESS & OPERATIONS

- **30× Revenue Growth:** Grew revenue from $22,000 to $500,000+ in 12 months while simultaneously operating all executive functions — CEO, CFO, CRO, and CIO
- **8(a) & WBE Certifications:** Led federal certification process positioning F&T Labs for government contracting; drives RFP strategy and business development for public health modernization engagements

Chief Information Officer & Chief Data Officer

Jul 2018 – Oct 2022

Lake County Health Department and Community Health Center · Waukegan, IL

Promoted to CIO/CDO Feb 2019 · Budget: $11.5M operational + $3M capital · 95-person reporting chain, 5 direct reports

SIGNATURE OUTCOMES

- **Nation-Leading Vaccine Platform:** Designed and built a vaccine scheduling and registration system that logged **40,000 registrations in 24 hours** and 200,000+ in the first weeks — built in 8 weeks from concept to live; earned national coverage in State Tech, GovTech, and ABC News
- **Health Equity:** Reduced COVID-19 death disparities between Black, white, and Hispanic residents by **40% in one year**; increased underrepresented community participation in health decisions by **250%**
- **Team Excellence:** Built 4 departments and 5 teams from scratch — **0% undesirable turnover**, **top 1% employee engagement scores** across all teams

ENTERPRISE LEADERSHIP

- **Technology Strategy:** Led enterprise-wide IT strategy covering infrastructure, security, telecommunications, service desk, EHR systems, analytics, and clinical applications across a complex FQHC and public health enterprise
- **Community Health Framework:** Built countywide improvement framework with **75 partner organizations**; COVID data dashboard reached **2 million+ views** in one year
- **25-Year Strategic Plan:** Led development and implementation of LCHD's long-range strategic plan; accountable for Community Health Assessment and Community Health Improvement Plan countywide

Manager, Healthcare Analytics

Jan 2017 – Jul 2018

Northwestern University · Chicago, IL

- **EHR Data Warehouse:** Directed implementation of an enterprise data warehouse unifying EHR data across **4 systems and 21 care locations** — complex multi-site integration at one of the nation's largest health networks

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (continued)

Manager, Business Intelligence & Clinical Analytics
2012 – Apr 2016

Children's National Medical Center · Washington, D.C.

Promoted through Clinical Informatics Analyst → Supervisory Clinical Informatics Analyst → Manager

- **Geospatial Discovery:** Applied GIS analysis to pediatric injury data — identified a cluster of burn cases concentrated in specific apartment buildings, traced to water heaters set dangerously high by a single landlord; analysis drove direct community advocacy and protective intervention for vulnerable children
- **Clinical Decision Support:** Led implementation of population health registries, enterprise data warehouse, and point-of-care decision support at a major pediatric health system — an early innovator in applied clinical informatics
- **Patent:** Received a patent for clinical informatics innovation developed during this tenure

Transportation Research Analyst
2011 – 2012

National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB) · Washington, D.C.

- Applied aviation human factors training to safety research across transportation modes — the foundational systems-thinking discipline that now informs Jefferson's approach to complex health IT architecture and failure-mode analysis

TECHNICAL SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

Cloud & AI Architecture
AWS (Bedrock, Lambda, S3, API Gateway, Cognito, CloudFormation), HIPAA-compliant multi-tenant design, RAG systems, agentic AI, LLM integration, compliant-by-design infrastructure

Data & Analytics
Enterprise data warehouse strategy, business intelligence, GIS/geospatial analysis, Tableau, clinical data analysis, population health analytics, data governance, statistics

Policy & Compliance
HIPAA, information security, ICD/CPT/HCPCS/SNOMED, pay-for-performance, community health assessment, health policy analysis

Health IT & Informatics
Epic EHR integration and consolidation, clinical decision support, FHIR, HL7, health information exchange (HIE), interoperability, population health registries, EHR strategy

Executive Leadership
CIO/CDO/CEO operations, budget management ($11.5M+), strategic planning, team building, board governance, change management, federal contracting (8a/WBE)

Platforms
AWS, Epic, Tableau, Salesforce Health Cloud, MuleSoft, custom data warehouse architectures

EDUCATION

Doctor of Public Health (DrPH) — In Progress
Johns Hopkins Bloomberg School of Public Health
Health Policy & Management · Public Health Informatics · Dissertation proposal submitted Feb 2026

MPH, Epidemiology & MPA, Public Administration *(concurrent)*
University of Illinois Springfield

B.S., Aeronautics — Magna Cum Laude
Embry-Riddle Aeronautical University
GPA 3.72 · Honors Program · PI, Hypoxia Research Lab · First-named author · Foundation for systems-thinking approach to complex technical environments

CREDENTIALS & RECOGNITION

CHCIO
Certified Healthcare Chief Information Officer — CHIME

CDH-E
Certified in Digital Health, Executive

BT150 Honoree — Constellation Research (2022)
Top global executives leading enterprise business transformation

Patent Holder
Clinical informatics innovation — Children's National Medical Center

Volunteer EMS / Firefighter
BLS certified · Former certified EMS provider (Virginia)

BOARD & COMMUNITY SERVICE

Lake County Forest Preserve Foundation — Board Member · Advocate for green infrastructure, outdoor access, and community health through natural spaces